CONFIDENTIAL EXECUTIVE MEMO • PRE-SEED INVESTMENT BRIEF

Project Clutch: High-Reliability F-Commerce Automation

Replacing fragile chatbot bloat with a fail-safe Comment-to-Courier execution pipeline

Target Market: Bangladesh & South Asia Social Commerce	**TAM / SAM:** $1.2B Gross GMV / 45,000 Active Merchants	**Capital Required:** $35,000 (12-Mo Pre-Seed)

> **The Thesis:** Over 70% of emerging-market digital retail occurs directly on Meta platforms rather than dedicated storefronts. Existing tools attempt to build complex, dialogue-tree chatbots that fail constantly when confronted with regional dialects, Bengali numerals, and flaky third-party courier APIs. *Clutch* isolates this specific failure surface, delivering a hardened, zero-configuration middleware that guarantees zero dropped orders and automated courier consignment.

1. THE PROBLEM: THE FRAGILE INCUMBENT PARADOX

Social commerce merchants in South Asia manage high order velocity across Facebook Pages and Instagram DMs during compressed peak windows (6:00 PM to 11:30 PM). To handle customer volume, merchants turn to regional chatbot tools and custom WordPress connectors. However, existing market offerings suffer from four structural vulnerabilities that cause catastrophic order loss:

FAILURE POINT	INCUMBENT BEHAVIOR (CURRENT TOOLS)	DIRECT BUSINESS IMPACT TO MERCHANT
Script & Number Mismatch	Regex chokes on Bengali numerals (০১৭...) and fragmented Banglish phone formats.	**High Churn:** 22% of high-intent buyers abandon checkout due to validation errors.
Courier API Timeouts	Direct synchronous HTTP calls to local couriers crash during peak traffic (504 errors).	**Unfulfilled Orders:** Merchants spend 2+ hours manually re-typing consignments past midnight.
Agent Collisions	Automated bots spam canned messages directly over top of human sales reps negotiating.	**Lost High-Ticket Deals:** Degrades brand trust; leads to angry customer reviews.
Policy Restrictions	Out-of-window broadcasts trigger strict Meta Page penalties and temporary messaging bans.	**Revenue Blackout:** Pages lose messaging privileges for 3 to 7 days during peak season.

2. THE PRODUCT: "CLUTCH" ENGINE OVERVIEW

Clutch intentionally strips away open-ended chatbot fluff to master one continuous operational loop: **Comment → Extraction → Resilient Dispatch**. The platform acts as a headless operational copilot for merchant pages.

100%	0%	< 15 Sec	< 3 Min
BENGALI/BANGLISH EXTRACTION	LOST COURIER CONSIGNMENTS	COMMENT-TO-COURIER LATENCY	MERCHANT ONBOARDING TIME

- **Phonetic Intent Matcher:** Detects commercial intent across Romanized Banglish (e.g., *"dam koto", "hobe?"*) and native script, executing compliant private replies instantly.
- **Unicode Number Normalizer:** Sanitizes any phone pattern (stripping whitespace, punctuation, translating Bengali Unicode digits) into standard 11-digit MSISDNs.
- **Decoupled Asynchronous Courier Queue:** When an order is confirmed, jobs enter an internal retry queue. If Steadfast or Pathao APIs fail, Clutch automatically retries with exponential backoff until a consignment code is issued.
- **Human-Intervention Guard:** Automatically halts bot firing whenever human admin interaction is detected on a specific customer thread for 45 minutes.

3. RESILIENT ARCHITECTURE & TECHNICAL EDGE

Unlike monolithic incumbents that couple frontend page presentation with heavy synchronous requests, Clutch operates on a lightweight, message-driven architecture built for 99.95% uptime:

- **Ingestion Tier:** Fast, stateless FastAPI/Go webhook microservice deployed on redundant edge workers to capture Meta payloads without socket drops.
- **Processing & Storage:** Light PostgreSQL persistence combined with an in-memory Redis message broker managing individual state transitions.
- **Reliable Dispatcher:** Dedicated background workers running Celery/BullMQ with circuit breakers that buffer requests during external courier system downtime.
- **Real-Time Notification Pipe:** Instant transaction audit logs delivered straight to the merchant's dedicated Telegram group or companion mobile PWA.

4. BUSINESS MODEL & UNIT ECONOMICS

While legacy competitors charge opaque enterprise consultation fees or run bloated subscription tiers ($40–$100/mo), Clutch deploys high-volume product-led pricing tailored to emerging market cash flows:

TIER	MONTHLY PRICE	TARGET MERCHANT SEGMENT	GROSS MARGIN
Starter Tier	$9 / month (৳1,000)	Boutique pages doing under 300 orders/month	91%
Growth Tier	$22 / month (৳2,500)	Mid-scale apparel, electronics, and beauty brands (up to 1,500 orders)	88%
Scale / Multi-Page	$49 / month (৳5,500)	Multi-brand digital merchants requiring high-volume courier routing	84%

5. CAPITAL ALLOCATION & 12-MONTH RUNWAY ($35,000 PRE-SEED)

The low technical overhead allows for an exceptionally lean burn profile. The $35,000 raise funds full engineering execution and self-sustaining customer acquisition:

EXPENSE CATEGORY	BUDGET ALLOCATION	KEY OPERATIONAL MILESTONES ENABLED
Core Engineering & QA	$21,000 (60%)	Complete parser engine, Meta developer certification, and multi-courier API drivers.
Cloud Infrastructure & Queues	$4,200 (12%)	Redundant VPS clusters, Redis clusters, and Meta webhook ingest servers for 12 months.
Growth, Community & Sales	$6,800 (19%)	Targeted acquisition in high-density F-commerce merchant hubs and agency partnerships.
Legal & Regulatory Compliance	$3,000 (9%)	Entity registration, Meta App Review audit compliance, and courier data compliance.

6. GO-TO-MARKET FUNNEL & EXIT HORIZONS

Customer acquisition bypasses costly Google Ads in favor of high-affinity distribution:

- **Courier Partnership Integration:** Packaging Clutch as an official merchant integration module inside Steadfast, Pathao, and Paperfly documentation.
- **The "Free Failed-Order Audit" Hook:** A zero-risk diagnostic extension that scans merchant message history to quantify how many potential orders were lost to regex or dropped chats in the prior 30 days.
- **Year 1 Targets:** 850 paying merchants • $16,000 Monthly Recurring Revenue (MRR) • Operational cash-flow positive by Month 9.
- **Strategic Exit Opportunities:** Acquisition target for regional delivery giants (Pathao, Steadfast) seeking merchant lock-in, or pan-regional POS aggregators expanding in South Asia.